

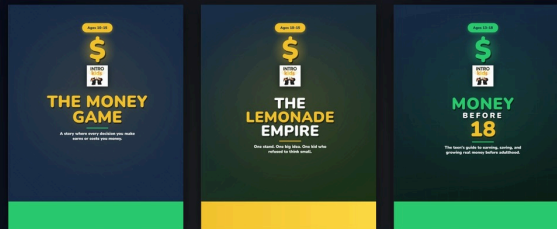
FREE PARENT GUIDE

7 Money Conversations Every Parent Should Have

Ten-minute talks that turn everyday moments into money lessons
your kids will actually remember.

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Why This Matters

Schools teach algebra, history, and science. But the one subject that will affect your child every single day of their adult life — money — is nowhere on the curriculum.

By age 15, your kid will already be making money decisions. Whether it's managing a first paycheck, understanding why things cost what they cost, or figuring out the difference between wanting something and needing it — these conversations shape how they handle money for decades.

You don't need to be a financial expert. You just need to start talking.

Here are seven conversations that take 10 minutes each and can change everything.

Conversation 1: What Is Money, Really?

Best age to start: 8–10

Most kids think money comes from ATMs or phones. Start here.

Ask your kid: "Where does the money come from before it gets to the ATM?"

Walk them through the cycle: work creates value, value earns money, money goes to a bank, the ATM is just a machine that holds it. This one conversation reframes money from "something that appears" to "something that's earned."

Go deeper: Read *The Money Game* together — it's a choose-your-path story where every decision earns or costs money, so kids feel how money is earned.

Conversation 2: Needs vs. Wants

Best age to start: 8–12

The exercise: Next time you're at a store, pick up two items — one your kid needs (school supplies) and one they want (a toy or snack). Ask: "If you could only buy one, which would you choose and why?"

Don't lecture. Let them reason through it. The goal isn't the "right" answer — it's building the habit of asking the question before spending.

Conversation 3: How Budgets Actually Work

Best age to start: 10–13

Give your kid \$20 (real or pretend) and a list of things to "buy" for the week: snacks, a small toy, saving for something bigger, and giving to someone. Let them divide it up.

When the money runs out before the list is done, that's the lesson. No lecture needed — the budget taught itself.

Go deeper: *The Money Game* turns these trade-offs into a game — kids make the choices and see their Money Score at the end. Kids remember games longer than talks.

Conversation 4: The Power of Saving (and Why It's Boring Until It's Not)

Best age to start: 9–13

Ask your kid: "If I gave you \$5 every week, how long would it take to buy [something they want that costs \$50–\$100]?"

Let them do the math. Then show them: "What if you saved \$10 a week instead?" Watch their face when the timeline shrinks.

Saving isn't exciting until kids see it working toward something THEY want. Make it personal.

Conversation 5: What Is a Business?

Best age to start: 10–14

Ask your kid: "If you could sell something to your friends or neighbors, what would it be?"

Don't shoot down ideas. A lemonade stand, custom bracelets, dog walking, lawn care — every answer is correct. Walk through the basics: What does it cost to make? What would you charge? How much would you keep?

This plants the seed that money isn't just earned from a job — it can be created.

Go deeper: *The Lemonade Empire* is a fast, funny story about building a business from one lemonade stand — and what happens when the first idea doesn't go to plan. It's the entrepreneurship conversation in story form.

Conversation 6: Debt Is Real (Even for Kids)

Best age to start: 12–15

The scenario: "Your friend lends you \$20 today, but wants \$25 back next week. Would you take the deal?"

This is interest, simplified. Most kids instinctively say "no way" — and that instinct is the lesson. Debt costs more than the original amount. Always.

Expand it: credit cards, car loans, student loans. Keep it simple. The point isn't to scare them — it's to make sure they understand the cost of borrowing before anyone offers them a credit card at 18.

Conversation 7: Your Money, Your Choices

Best age to start: 13–15

Ask your kid: "When you're 18 and making your own money, what's the first thing you'd do with your first paycheck?"

Listen without correcting. Then ask: "What about the second paycheck? The tenth?"

This conversation is about identity. Are they a saver? A spender? An investor? A giver? There's no wrong answer — but thinking about it before the money starts flowing is what separates financially confident adults from financially stressed ones.

Go deeper: *Money Before 18* is built for this exact age range — real financial concepts, real scenarios, no baby talk. It bridges the gap between "kid money lessons" and actual adult financial literacy.

What's Next?

These seven conversations don't require a finance degree. They require 10 minutes each and the willingness to start.

If you want to go further, Intro Kids! has three books that turn these conversations into stories, activities, and real lessons your kids will actually remember:

The Money Game — Earning, saving and everyday money decisions (ages 10–15)

The Lemonade Empire — Entrepreneurship and building something from scratch (ages 10–15)

Money Before 18 — Real-world financial literacy for teens (ages 13–18)

Each book is **\$5.99** as an instant digital download or **\$10.99** in paperback:

- The Money Game — Digital: jwatbiz.gumroad.com/l/mztaob · Paperback: www.lulu.com/shop/tiesha-m-walters-and-wayne-walters/the-money-game/paperback/product-q6q6mz5.html
- The Lemonade Empire — Digital: jwatbiz.gumroad.com/l/bcozhu · Paperback: www.lulu.com/shop/tiesha-m-walters-and-wayne-walters/the-lemonade-empire/paperback/product-e7q7vme.html
- Money Before 18 — Digital: jwatbiz.gumroad.com/l/wddjtg · Paperback: www.lulu.com/shop/tiesha-m-walters-and-wayne-walters/money-before-18/paperback/product-rmkm97m.html

See the whole series: www.jwatenterprisesinc.com/intro-kids.html

Intro Kids! is a financial literacy brand for kids and teens by Tiesha M. Walters and Wayne Walters, published by Jwat Enterprise Inc. We believe every kid deserves to understand money before they're expected to manage it.